

(Don't Write anything in this Area)

- Q2. (a) What are the two main schools in economic anthropology? What are the fundamental differences in their approach to the study of economic systems in simple societies? (20 marks)

Economic Anthropology can be defined as the cross cultural analysis of economies of societies across the world.

It was the pioneering work of Dr. Malinowski in Trobriand Islands which attracted the attention of Anthropologists to study the economic activities of simple societies.

Dr. Karl Polanyi in his book "the Great Transformation" has noted two schools in economic anthropology.

- (i) Formalist School + (ii) Substantivist School

① Formalist School →

Famous formalists are Dr. Schneider, Dr. Herkovits and Dr. Raymond Firth.

According to formalist school :-

- (i) Every individual takes his decision rationally.
He uses all the information available to

No need of this much intro.
↓
Introduce the question asked.

him, make proper calculations and then take economic decisions.

(ii) Everybody lives in Scarcity of Resources and unlimited wants.

(iii) ~~Also~~ people feel satisfaction in saving scarce resources and Profit Maximization.

good understanding

That is, All the fundamentals of economics are applicable to Tribal economies / Simple Societies too.

Criticism

① Prattis has said this view to be tautological:

i.e. If someone sacrifices his time & health in help other, formalists will say he is adding value to helping others.

② Economic view that do not consider social relations is bound to be flawed.

Formalists keep economy above the society. it is an individualistic approach.

③ SUBSTANTIVIST VIEW

Leading proponent of this view are Dr. Karl Polanyi, Sahlins, etc.

According to Dr. Polanyi, social relations of the people need to be considered while studying their economic activities.

According to Dr. Mark Granovetter, the economic transactions of simple societies are embedded in their social relations with each other.

[For Example] → In 'Kula ring' described

by Dr. Malinowski, people risk their lives and take dangerous voyages (to exchange economically irrelevant items)

However due to this exchange their kinship bonds gets stranger.

main points for substantivism

- ① Embedded
- ② Integration
- ③ Institutional

→ As Economy is placed below society.

→ As this is social approach

Dr Sahlin has commented that Simple Societies do not maximise, they optimise.

Criticisms

→ In the current world, there is hardly any pre-industrial society left.

→ Scarcity of resources can happen everywhere and anywhere.

After Globalization, the Simple economies too are moving towards the modern economies.

Time is right to apply an interdisciplinary approach; both formalists & substantivists ✓

need to come together to study the Simple economies in these changing times.

* Read the question carefully.

When there are 2 or 3 parts in the question, give due importance to all those parts.

↳ In this question, first half of the question is not given its due importance.

Marks: 104 ✓

Intro: 1

Body: 8 ✓

Conclusion: 1

Total:

Comments:

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